

General Knowledge

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STUDY NOTES

National Awards



National Awards

Awards and **honours** are significant instruments for recognizing and celebrating excellence across various domains of human endeavour. These accolades, whether bestowed upon individuals, groups, or organizations, serve as tokens of appreciation for outstanding achievements, dedication, and innovation.

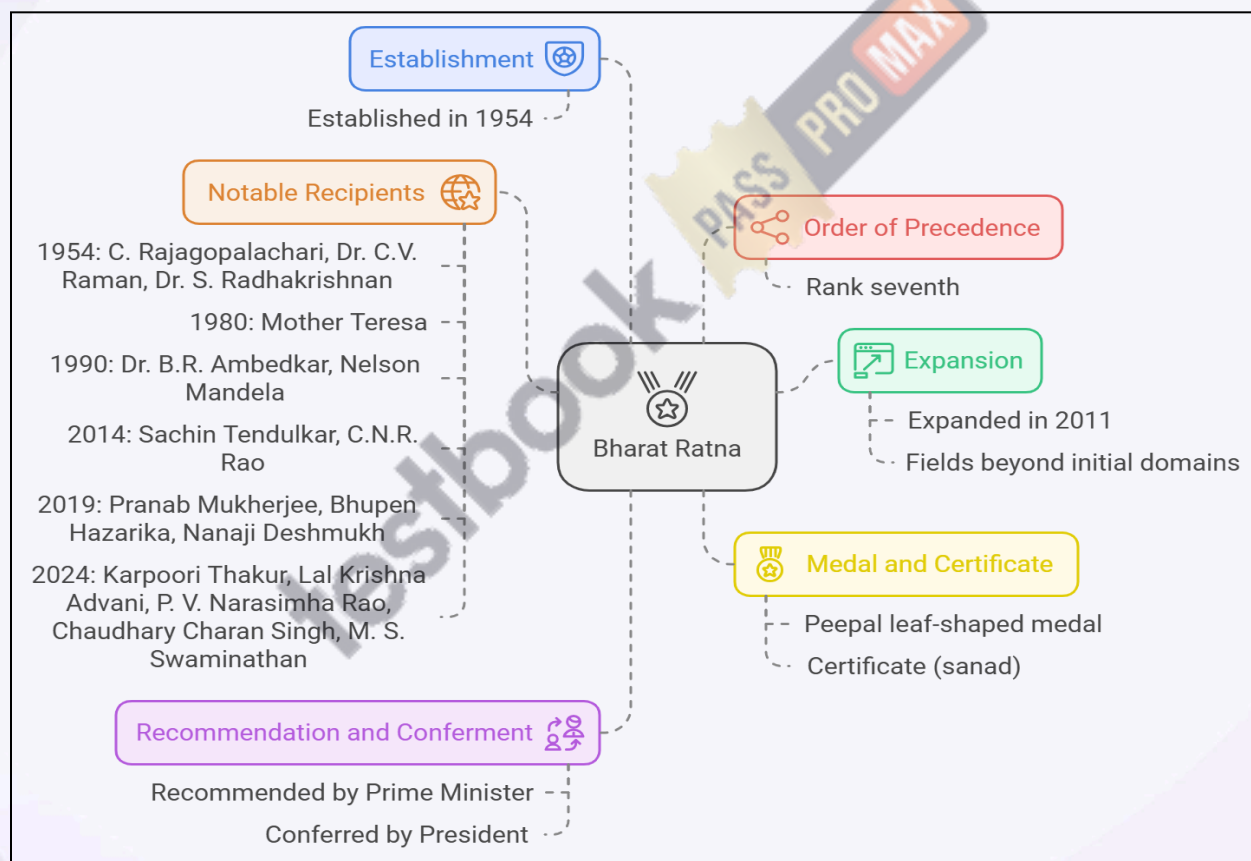
- Institutions like the **Government of India**, private organizations, and international bodies play pivotal roles in instituting these awards to ensure that exceptional contributions do not go unnoticed.
- The awards conferred by the Government of India, such as the **Bharat Ratna** and **Padma Awards**, reflect the nation's commitment to acknowledging exceptional contributions to society.
- Similarly, global recognitions like the **Nobel Prize**, **Grammy Award**, and **Abel Prize** bring attention to extraordinary achievements that transcend national boundaries.
- These awards also highlight the values, traditions, and priorities of the awarding body, emphasizing fields that are vital for societal progress.



Awards by the Government of India

Bharat Ratna

- The highest civilian award in India, Bharat Ratna, translates to "Jewel of India." It honours individuals for their exceptional contributions in any field of human endeavour.
- Established in 1954.
- Expanded in 2011 to include achievements in any field beyond the initial domains of art, literature, science, and public service.
- Recommended by the Prime Minister of India and conferred by the President of India.
- No monetary reward; recipients receive a peepal leaf-shaped medal and a certificate (sanad).
- Awardees rank seventh in the Indian Order of Precedence.



- **Notable Recipients:**
 - **1954** (First Recipients): C. Rajagopalachari, Dr. C.V. Raman, Dr. S. Radhakrishnan.
 - **1980:** Mother Teresa (social worker).

- **1990:** Dr. B.R. Ambedkar (Chief Architect of the Indian Constitution), Nelson Mandela (South African leader).
- **2014:** Sachin Tendulkar (cricketer), C.N.R. Rao (scientist).
- **2019:** Pranab Mukherjee (13th President of India), Bhupen Hazarika (musician), Nanaji Deshmukh (social activist).
- **2024:** Karpoori Thakur (Posthumous) - Social justice and politics, Lal Krishna Advani - Politics and governance, P. V. Narasimha Rao (Posthumous) - Economic reforms and politics, Chaudhary Charan Singh (Posthumous) - Agriculture and farmers' advocacy, M. S. Swaminathan (Posthumous) - Agricultural science (Father of the Green Revolution)

Padma Awards

- Instituted in 1954, these awards recognize exceptional contributions across fields such as sports, arts, literature, public service, science, and education.
- It is categorized into **three categories**.
 - **Padma Vibhushan:** Exceptional and distinguished service (2nd highest civilian honor).
 - **Padma Bhushan:** Distinguished service of a high order (3rd highest civilian honor).
 - **Padma Shri:** Distinguished service (4th highest civilian honor).
- Presented **annually** on **Republic Day**.
- Recipients receive a medallion and certificate but no monetary reward.
- Government servants (except doctors and scientists) are ineligible.

2024 Padma Awards:

- **Total Awards:** 132, including 2 duo cases.
 - **Padma Vibhushan:** 5 recipients
 - **Padma Bhushan:** 17 recipients
 - **Padma Shri:** 110 recipients
- **Notable Facts:**
 - 30 women awardees.
 - 8 foreigners/NRIs/PIOs/OCIs.
 - 9 posthumous awardees.

Padma Vibhushan

Name	Field	State/Region/Country
Vyjayantimala Bali	Art	Tamil Nadu
Konidela Chiranjeevi	Art	Andhra Pradesh
M. Venkaiah Naidu	Public Affairs	Andhra Pradesh
Bindeshwar Pathak (Posthumous)	Social Work	Bihar
Padma Subrahmanyam	Art	Tamil Nadu

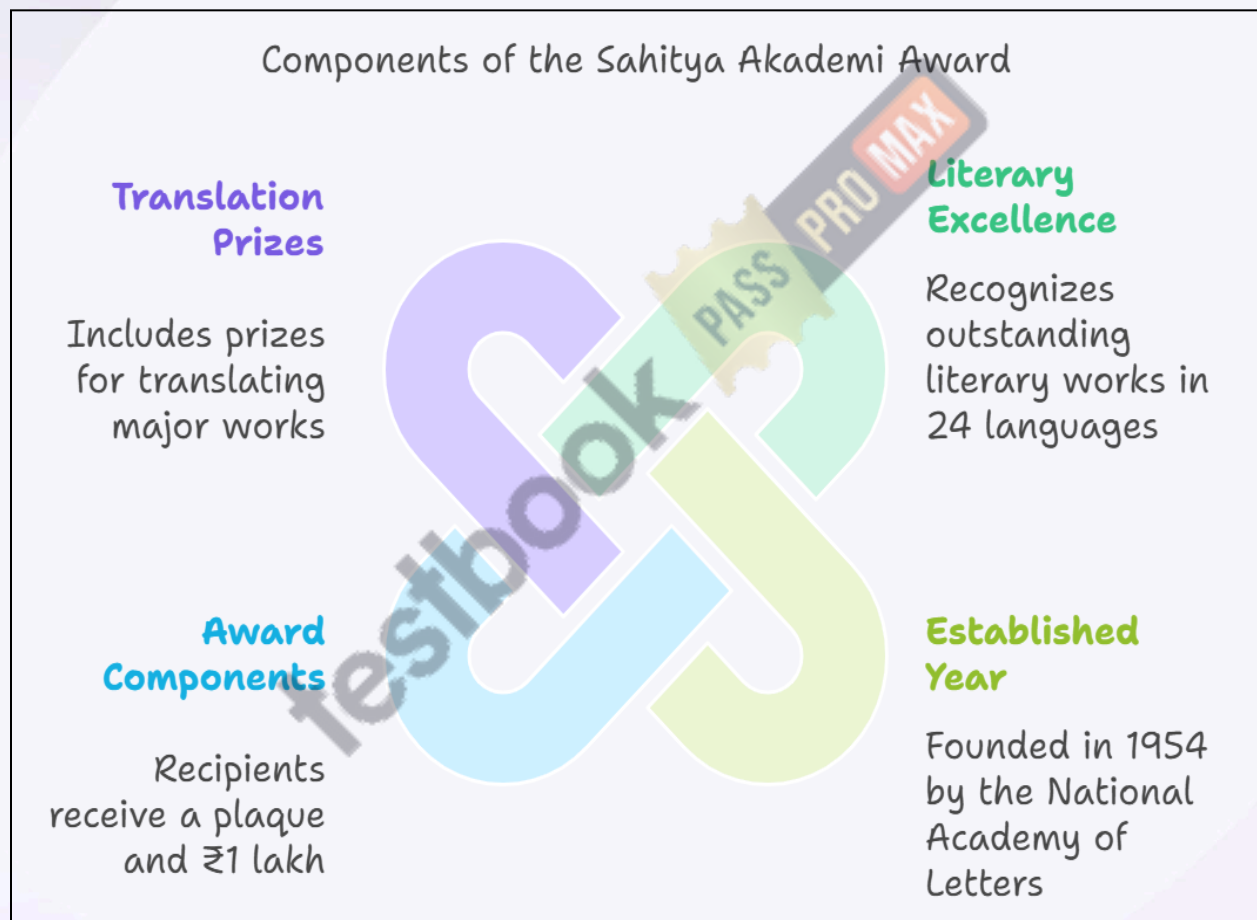
Padma Bhushan

Name	Field	State/Region/ Country
M. Fathima Beevi (Posthumous)	Public Affairs	Kerala
Hormusji N. Cama	Literature & Education (Journalism)	Maharashtra
Mithun Chakraborty	Art	West Bengal
Sitaram Jindal	Trade & Industry	Karnataka
Young Liu	Trade & Industry	Taiwan
Ashwin Balachand Mehta	Medicine	Maharashtra
Satyabrata Mookherjee (Posthumous)	Public Affairs	West Bengal
Ram Naik	Public Affairs	Maharashtra
Tejas Madhusudan Patel	Medicine	Gujarat

Cultural and Literary Awards

Sahitya Akademi Award

- Recognizes literary excellence in any of the 24 recognized languages.
- Established in 1954 by the National Academy of Letters.
- Recipients are honoured with a plaque and a cash prize of ₹1 lakh.
- The award also includes translation prizes for translating major works into recognized languages.
- Author Krishnamurthy Biligere considers his Kendriya Sahitya Akademi win an award for his relentless efforts to empower the young mind.



Sahitya Akademi Yuva Puraskar 2024

Language	Winner	Book Title
Bengali	Sutapa Chakraborty	Deraje Halud Ful, Gatajanma

Bodo	Rani Baro	Saikhlum
Dogri	Heena Choudhary	Ik Rang Tere Range Chaa
English	K. Vaishali	Homeless: Growing up Lesbian and Dyslexic in India
Gujarati	Rinku Rathod	To Tame Raaji?
Hindi	Gaurav Pandey	Smritiyon Ke Beech Ghiri Hai Prithvi
Kannada	Shruthi BR	Zero Balance
Kashmiri	Mohd Ashraf Ziya	Aene Baedas
Konkani	Adwait Salgaonkar	Pedanyacha Samaaram
Maithili	Rinki Jha Rishika	Nadi Ghati Sabhyata
Malayalam	Shyamkrishnan R	Meeshakkallan
Manipuri	Waikhom Chingkheinganba	Ashiba Turel

Jnanpith Award

- Known as the "Seat of Knowledge" award, it honors literary contributions in 23 languages (22 Schedule VIII languages + English).
- Established in 1961 by the Bharatiya Jnanpith Trust.
- Recipients receive ₹11 lakh, a bronze statue of Goddess Saraswati, and a citation.
- The 58th Jnanpith Award for 2024 was given to Urdu poet and lyricist Gulzar and Sanskrit scholar Jagadguru Rambhadracharya

Saraswati Samman

- The award is given annually by the K K Birla Foundation for outstanding literary works in 22 Indian languages. The award includes a citation, a plaque, and a cash prize of Rs 15 lakh.

- Prabha Varma won the 2024 Saraswati Samman for his Malayalam poem Roudra Sathwikam.
- The first recipient of the Saraswati Samman was Harivansh Rai Bachchan.
- Malayalam received the Saraswati Samman for the first time in 1995, through Balamani Amma.
- The K K Birla Foundation also institutes the Vyas Samman and the Bihari Puraskar, which are other literary awards.
- The Sahitya Akademi, a government-funded institution, recognizes and encourages outstanding works of literature in various Indian languages.

Vyas Samman

- The **Vyas Samman** is an annual literary award established by the **K.K. Birla Foundation** in 1991 to recognize outstanding Hindi literary works published in the past 10 years.
- The award includes a **cash prize** of ₹4,00,000 and is conferred upon Indian authors who have made a significant contribution to Hindi literature.
- The award is typically presented in a formal ceremony attended by prominent literary figures and intellectuals.
- In **2023**, the **Vyas Samman** was awarded to **Pushpa Bharati** for her 2016 memoir, *Yaadein, Yaadein!... Aur Yaadein*.
- **Pushpa Bharati's memoir** reflects on her life experiences, capturing the essence of personal memories and emotions.
- In **2022**, **Dr Gyan Chaturvedi** was honoured with the award for his satirical novel, *Pagalkhana* (2018), which humorously critiques social issues.
- **Chitra Mudgal** was the **first woman** to receive the Vyas Samman for her novel *Avaan*, which explores human relationships and social themes.
- The Vyas Samman is recognized for its emphasis on **literary excellence, originality**, and the **depth of insight** that the awarded works offer into contemporary society.
- The **K.K. Birla Foundation**, through this award, aims to promote **Hindi literature** and encourage literary talent in India.

Scientific Awards

Shanti Swarup Bhatnagar Prize

- **Dr. Purabi Saikia** won the **2024 Shanti Swarup Bhatnagar Award** for her significant contributions to **environmental science**.
- She is an **Associate Professor** in the **Department of Botany** at the **Institute of Science, Banaras Hindu University**.
- The **Shanti Swarup Bhatnagar Prize** is awarded annually to **Indian citizens, Overseas Citizens of India (OCI)**, and **Persons of Indian Origin (PIO)** who have made exceptional contributions in the field of **science and technology**.
- The prize is conferred in **seven disciplines**:
 - Biological Sciences
 - Chemical Sciences
 - Earth, Atmosphere, Ocean, and Planetary Sciences
 - Engineering Sciences
 - Mathematical Sciences
 - Medical Sciences
 - Physical Sciences
- The recipients of the Shanti Swarup Bhatnagar Award are selected by the **CSIR Advisory Committees**, based on their outstanding research and contributions.
- The **names of the recipients** are announced annually on **CSIR Foundation Day**, which is observed on **September 26**.
- A **formal ceremony** is organized by **CSIR** to present the award to the winners.
- The **CSIR** reserves the right to **withhold the award** in a given discipline if it does not find any suitable candidate for that year.
- The Shanti Swarup Bhatnagar Prize is one of the **highest scientific honours** in India, recognizing excellence in research and innovation across various scientific fields.